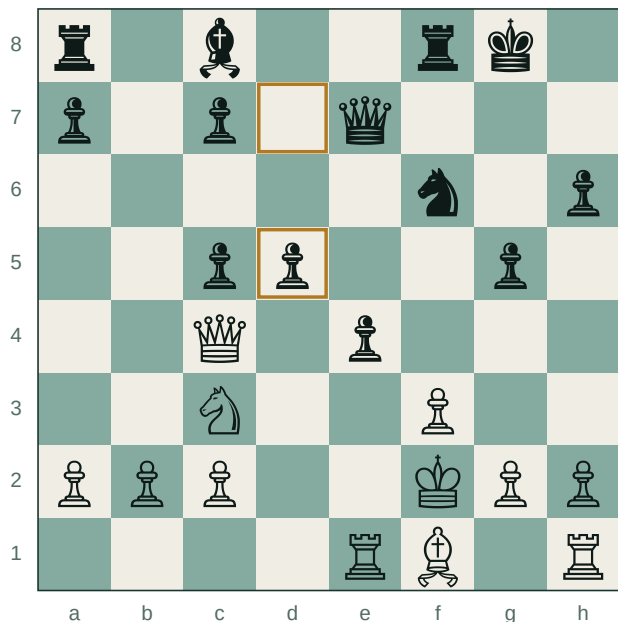


Active defensive resources: White, move 16

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 15...d5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16. Nxd5 Ng4+ 17. Kg1

16.Nxd5 The knight captures the pawn on d5. From d5 it attacks queen on e7 and knight on f6. Recorded reply: **16...Ng4+**.

17.Kg1 The king moves from f2 to g1.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on d5.